OUR METABOLIC MISMATCH

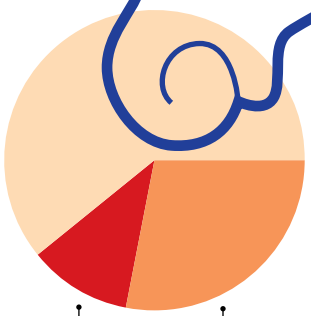
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INDIA IS FACING A QUIET DIETARY SHIFT—one reshaping the country's metabolic health. The latest ICMR-INDIAB (Indian Council of Medical Research-India Diabetes) dietary study, published recently in *Nature Medicine*, maps what Indians are eating today and how it is linked to rising diabetes, obesity and prediabetes. Drawing on large, nationally representative data, the study shows that while calorie intake may be adequate, macronutrient balance is not. Indian diets remain heavily tilted towards carbohydrates, with insufficient protein and poor-quality fats. Simply replacing rice or wheat with millets or whole grains, the researchers note, does not meaningfully lower metabolic risk unless overall carbohydrate intake is reduced. Instead, even modest shifts—such as replacing a small proportion of carbs with protein—show measurable health benefits. The findings point towards a deeper reset of the Indian plate: fewer refined carbs, more protein, better fats and lower added sugar.



THE INDIAN PLATE

What Indians are eating today and what it's doing to our bodies



CARBOHYDRATE
62-65%
of daily calories come from carbohydrates

PROTEIN
<12%
of total energy intake comes from protein

FAT
<30%
Fat intake, which is near national recommendations but quality is poor

Diets are dominated by high-glycaemic staples (that cause sharp blood-sugar spikes) eaten in large quantities. This pattern delivers quick energy but poor metabolic protection. It drives repeated glucose spikes and low meal satiety

THE OUTCOMES

- Higher prevalence of Type 2 diabetes
- Rising abdominal obesity, even at lower BMIs
- A growing pool of people with prediabetes